

Miguel Fajardo-Steinhäuser

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[Academic Website](#) | [in](#) | [O](#)

PhD Economist with expertise in causal inference, experimentation, and applied econometrics. Experienced in designing RCTs, identifying and leveraging natural experiments, analyzing large administrative datasets, and translating complex findings into actionable insights

Education

London School of Economics PhD Economics - with Distinction in MRes Program	2020 -
<i>Field Courses: Industrial Organisation, International Trade, Development Economics</i>	
London School of Economics MSc Economics - with Distinction	2017-2018
Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität Munich BSc Economics	2014-2017

Selected Research Projects

[Peace Dividends: The Economic Effects of Colombia's Peace Agreement](#)

- Built Diff-in-Diff and RDD models on 10+ years of admin data covering 1000+ municipalities
- Processed and combined multiple large-scale datasets, including violence records, economic indicators, survey data, and satellite imagery

[Can Digital Aid Deliver During Humanitarian Crises?](#)

(with Michael Callen, Michael Findley and Tarek Ghani, *Forthcoming, Management Science*)

- Designed and implemented RCT testing an innovative, tech-based approach to delivering humanitarian aid with 2,400+ participants in Afghanistan
- Results adopted by World Food Programme to scale digital payments to 100,000+ households

[Job Market Paper: Soft Power Through \(Humanitarian\) Aid: Evidence from an RCT in Pakistan](#)

- Managed end-to-end experimental design with 2,500 participants across 36 communities
- Designed behavioural games to generate incentive-compatible measures of sensitive outcomes

Research Employment

Pre-Doctoral Fellow LSE, Profs. Camille Landais & Johannes Spinnewijn	2019 - 2020
<i>Analysed large administrative datasets on employment and welfare policies using Stata, R, and Python</i>	
<i>Developed and calibrated structural economic models; Applied machine learning methods for prediction</i>	

Pre-Doctoral Fellow LSE, Prof. Nava Ashraf	2018 - 2019
<i>Managed full research pipeline from hypothesis development through data analysis and paper drafting</i>	
<i>Coordinated field experiments including survey design, implementation, and statistical analysis</i>	

Teaching Fellow/Graduate Teaching Assistant (LSE)	2018 -
<i>Econometrics and Statistics courses at the BSc., MSc., and PhD level</i>	
<i>Impact Evaluation and Behavioural Economics courses at the MPA and Executive level</i>	

Technical Skills

Stata (expert): Data cleaning, panel/time-series analysis, causal inference methods, custom programs
Python (intermediate): pandas, NumPy, matplotlib, statsmodels, scipy, basic scikit-learn
R (intermediate): tidyverse, ggplot2, sf for spatial analysis, caret for ML
SQL (learning): Basic queries, joins, aggregations

Professional Service & Awards

Over £500,000 in academic grants received to fund research projects as PI or Co-PI
Presented research at 20+ international conferences; peer reviewer for Review of Economic Studies, Journal of Politics, and other top journals in economics and political science
Association for Comparative Economic Studies Dissertation Fellowship (2024) & Research Prize (2023)
LSE Economics Department PhD Award + ESRC PhD Scholarship

Personal Details

Languages: Spanish, English and German; Citizenship: Colombia, Germany, UK